

TONG, Zheng (Patrick)

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Computational Social Science; Political Communication; AI and Communication Ethics; Gender Studies; Social Marginalized Groups; Migration Studies; Causal Inference; Text Analysis

EDUCATION**The University of Hong Kong****Sep. 2025 – Nov. 2026 [expected]***Master of Social Sciences in the field of Social Data Analytics*

Hong Kong SAR, China

- **GPA:** 3.66/4.30
- **Major Courses:** Introduction to Social Data Analytics (A+); Programming for Social Scientists (A); Statistical Foundations (A-); Machine Learning (B+); Natural Language Processing and Social Research; Social Network Analysis

Macau University of Science and Technology**Sep. 2021 – Jun. 2025***Bachelor of Arts in Journalism and Communication (Major in Communication)*

Macau SAR, China

- **GPA:** 3.77/4.00 (Top 1%)
- **Major Courses:** Social Statistics (A+); Mathematics and Logic (A+); Data Journalism (A+); Advanced Theories in Communication (A+); Digital Narrative (A+); Audience Analysis (A); Communication Psychology (A)
- **Honors & Awards:** Dean's Honor List & Dean's Honor List Scholarship (every academic year)

National University of Singapore**Jun. 2025 – Jul. 2025***Summer School for Social Science Research Methods*

Singapore

- Completed intensive training in Survey Research (Distinction) and AI & Experimental Methods (Merit), with a focus on applying computational tools to rigorous social science research
- Developed hands-on expertise in sampling strategies, survey mode selection, questionnaire design, and statistical weighting
- Applied LLMs and R to experimental research tasks, including stimuli generation, coding and analysis automation, randomization design, and survey/conjoint experiment design

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE**Exclusionary Populism in the U.S.: From Party-wide Patterns to Trump's Rhetoric** (Single-authored)

Accepted for presentation at International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR) 2026, Political Communication Research Section (POL); selected as Panel Chair

Galway, Ireland, Jun. – Jul. 2026

- Conducted an independent study of exclusionary populist rhetoric in U.S. presidential campaign speeches using a party-month panel (1952–2024) based on the Annenberg Presidential Database and LIWC-based text measures
- Examined partisan differences in “they”–“we” framing, modeled the dynamic effects of elite- and people-centered cues, and developed an Exclusionary Populism Index (EPI) to trace rhetorical shifts over time, especially in the Trump era
- Built a reproducible analytical workflow in Python for text processing, longitudinal modeling, and visualization of political communication patterns

When the Dead Seem Present: Perceived Realism, Social Presence, and Psychological Mechanisms in AI-based Digital Resurrection (Single-authored)

Accepted for presentation at International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR) 2026, Ethics of Society and Ethics of Communication Working Group (ETH)

Galway, Ireland, Jun. – Jul. 2026

- Developed an ethics-centered research framework for AI-based digital resurrection, examining how perceived realism shapes behavioral intention through emotional authenticity/comfort and uncanny discomfort, conditional on social presence
- Designed a preregistered between-subjects online survey experiment using Qualtrics, with a three-condition manipulation of technical fidelity in AI-generated memorial videos and an intended sample in mainland China
- Proposed a moderated parallel mediation strategy with robustness checks for attrition, covariate imbalance, and scale validity, integrating experimental design with computational and communication research perspectives

Speaking as the People, the Protector, or the Provocateur: Rhetorical Persona Types in U.S. Presidential Campaign Speeches (1952–2024) (Single-authored)

Submitted to National Communication Association (NCA) 2026, Political Communication Division

- Conducted an independent study of U.S. presidential campaign speeches (1952–2024), examining whether candidates speak in recurring rhetorical personae rather than along a single populism continuum
- Analyzed multidimensional rhetorical patterns across people-centered language, anti-elite appeals, policy-oriented discourse, and threat-based rhetoric using full-text transcripts and LIWC-based lexical indicators
- Designed a person-centered analytical framework using latent profile analysis (LPA) to identify speech-level persona types, generate candidate-level rhetorical signatures, and assess variation across parties, periods, and candidates

When Home Moves Away: The Causal Effect of Parental Rural-to-Urban Migration on Rural-Origin Children's Intergenerational Ties in China (Single-authored)

Submitted to National Communication Association (NCA) 2026, Family Communication Division

- Conducted an independent study of how parental rural-to-urban migration affects rural-origin children's intergenerational ties in China, distinguishing three migration types of left-behind, co-migrant, and non-migrant children
- Used China Family Panel Studies (CFPS) panel data to examine changes in parent-child communication, emotional attention, parental monitoring, and conflict as outcomes of family migration arrangements
- Applied a causal inference framework using propensity-score matching (PSM) and difference-in-differences (DiD) to estimate migration effects over time and improve comparability between treated and control groups

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Southern Metropolis Daily

Jun. 2024 – Sep. 2024

News Reporter and Editor Intern

Zhuhai, China

- Gathered, wrote, and edited daily news articles or videos per week, covering a wide range of topics including politics, local issues, and economics
- Curated digital content layouts and personalized news recommendations, helping improve click-through performance on the featured homepage
- Digitized and archived high-performing legacy articles to enrich the newspaper's online content library

Shenzhen Special Zone Daily

Jun. 2023 – Aug. 2023

News Reporter Intern

Shenzhen, China

- Investigated the social impact of urbanization on migrant workers through stakeholder collaboration and socioeconomic data analysis and visualization
- Conducted field interviews with urban planners, NGOs, and affected migrant workers to inform a three-part feature series
- Authored a feature series that boosted online engagement and was cited by local NGOs and policy advisors

Wuhan Traffic Broadcasting Station

Jun. 2022 – Aug. 2022

New Media Editor Intern

Wuhan, China

- Managed official social media platforms (Weibo, Douyin, WeChat), producing news and video content for daily updates
- Collected, visualized, and published COVID-19 case trajectory data to guide public safety decisions during the pandemic, reaching a broad online audience
- Created multimedia content across platforms, contributing to stronger audience engagement across daily posts

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Macau University of Science and Technology Volunteer Association

Dec. 2021 – Feb. 2025

Head of the Secretariat

- Streamlined cross-department operations by building daily management processes and performance tracking; organized 20+ volunteer initiatives (e.g., blood donation, community clean-ups) engaging over a thousand students
- Coordinated internal communications, meeting records, and event logistics across departments, ensuring smooth execution of association activities and more efficient collaboration among student volunteers

MISCELLANEOUS

- **Skills:** Python, R, SPSS, Gephi, ATLAS.ti (*Certified Student Trainer*), NVivo, Adobe XD & Photoshop, Microsoft Office Suite
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (Proficiency), Cantonese (Basic)
- **Activities:** Freelance Editor – Contributed to a student-led workshop community (AP1xClub) by supporting peer-sharing events and alumni talks, including sessions on academic writing & literature review, database searching, AI-assisted research workflow; collaborated with Macau local shops to develop integrated marketing campaigns (copywriting, IMC strategies, cross-platform social media content)